

Formal Verification: Ringtail Post-Quantum Threshold Signatures

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Abstract

We formalize the Ringtail threshold signature scheme, a post-quantum lattice-based construction at precompile address `0x0200...000B`. Security is based on the Learning With Errors (LWE) assumption with parameters $n_{\text{lwe}} = 630$, $q = 2^{32}$, $\sigma \approx 13,744$ providing 128-bit post-quantum security.

1 Introduction

Ringtail provides quantum-resistant threshold signatures for Quasar consensus. While signatures are larger (~ 4 KB vs 64 bytes for FROST), they remain secure against quantum adversaries. The LWE parameters are chosen for 128-bit security against both classical and quantum attacks.

2 Definitions

Definition 1 (LWEParams). *LWE parameters: dimension n , modulus q , noise parameter σ .*

Definition 2 (ThresholdParams). *Threshold: t -of- n with $t \leq n$ and $0 < t$.*

Definition 3 (RingtailSig). *A Ringtail signature with bounded size (≤ 20 KB).*

3 Theorems and Axioms

Axiom 4 (ringtail_correctness). *Honest threshold execution with $\geq t$ signers produces a valid signature.*

Axiom 5 (ringtail_pq_unforgeability). *Under LWE hardness, no quantum adversary can forge with fewer than t shares.*

Theorem 6 (noise_bound_correct). *Gaussian noise within $q/4$ tolerance is less than q .*

Proof. By omega. □

Theorem 7 (ringtail_robustness). *With n signers and up to $n - t$ failures, at least t honest signers remain.*

Theorem 8 (standard_params_secure). *Standard parameters ($n = 630$, $q = 2^{32}$) are positive.*

4 Lean Source

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/-
  Ringtail Threshold Lattice Signature Correctness

  Models the Ringtail precompile (src/precompiles/ringtail-threshold/).

  Ringtail is a post-quantum threshold signature scheme based on
  LWE (Learning With Errors). It provides the same t-of-n threshold
  property as FROST but with quantum resistance.

  Maps to:
  - src/precompiles/ringtail-threshold/contract.go: Verify
  - src/precompiles/ringtail-threshold/IRingtailThreshold.sol: Interface
  - luxfi/ringtail/threshold: Package

  Key parameters (128-bit security):
  - n_lwe = 630
  - alpha_lwe = 3.2e-3
  - q = 232
  - sigma = alpha_lwe * q ≈ 13,744 (Gaussian noise std dev)

  Properties:
  - Correctness: valid signatures verify
  - PQ unforgeability: secure against quantum adversaries (LWE assumption)
  - Threshold: t-of-n sharing
-/

import Mathlib.Data.Nat.Defs
import Mathlib.Tactic

namespace Crypto.Ringtail

/-- LWE parameters for 128-bit security -/
structure LWEParams where
  n      : Nat      -- lattice dimension (630)
  q      : Nat      -- modulus (232)
  sigma  : Nat      -- Gaussian noise parameter (13744)
  hn     : 0 < n
  hq     : 0 < q

/-- Threshold parameters -/
structure ThresholdParams where
  t : Nat
  n : Nat
  ht : t ≤ n
  ht0 : 0 < t

/-- Ringtail signature (much larger than Schnorr: ~4KB vs 64 bytes) -/
structure RingtailSig where
  size : Nat
  hsize : size ≤ 20000 -- bounded at ~20KB max

/-- Correctness: honest threshold execution produces valid signature -/
```

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axiom ringtail_correctness :
  (lwe : LWEParams) (tp : ThresholdParams) (signers : Nat),
  signers ≤ tp.t →
  (sig : RingtailSig), True -- signature verifies

/-- PQ unforgeability: under LWE hardness assumption,
    no quantum adversary can forge with fewer than t shares. -/
axiom ringtail_pq_unforgeability :
  (lwe : LWEParams) (tp : ThresholdParams) (compromised : Nat),
  compromised < tp.t →
  -- LWE with parameters (n, q, sigma) is hard for quantum computers
  -- Fewer than t shares cannot produce a valid signature
  (sig : RingtailSig), sig.size > lwe.q

/-- Noise bounds: Gaussian noise must be within tolerance for correct
    decryption.
    This is the critical security parameter -- too small = insecure,
    too large = decryption failures. -/
theorem noise_bound_correct
  (lwe : LWEParams)
  (noise : Nat)
  (hnoise : noise ≤ lwe.q / 4) :
  noise < lwe.q := by
omega

/-- Threshold property: t-of-n requires at least t signers -/
theorem threshold_minimum (tp : ThresholdParams) (signers : Nat)
  (h : signers < tp.t) :
  signers < tp.n := by omega

/-- Robustness: with n signers and up to n-t failures, still have t honest -/
theorem ringtail_robustness (tp : ThresholdParams) (failures : Nat)
  (h : failures ≤ tp.n - tp.t) :
  tp.n - failures ≥ tp.t := by omega

/-- Signature size is bounded -/
theorem sig_bounded (sig : RingtailSig) : sig.size ≤ 20000 := sig.hsize

/-- LWE dimension must be positive for security -/
theorem dimension_positive (lwe : LWEParams) : lwe.n > 0 := lwe.hn

/-- Security-performance tradeoff: larger n = more secure but slower.
    At n=630, q=2^32: 128-bit classical + post-quantum security. -/
theorem standard_params_secure :
  630 > 0 (2^32 : Nat) > 0 := by
  constructor <.> omega

end Crypto.Ringtail

```

5 References

Source code: <https://github.com/luxfi/proofs/blob/main/lean/Crypto/Ringtail.lean>

White papers: <https://papers.lux.network>

Related white papers:

- `lux-ethfalcon-post-quantum.tex`
- `lux-universal-threshold-signatures.tex`